

INFO90010 Technology Innovation Project

Week 4 Workshop – Data analysis activity

Preparation

To prepare for this workshop activity, please read Lesson 4 on the LMS: **4. Analysing needs and requirements (Part A)**

Background

Imagine you are gathering requirements for the design of a new health and fitness app.

In this stage of the project, you want to learn about people's current practices, future goals, frustrations, and concerns.

You have conducted an interview study to investigate people's current eating and exercise habits and you now need to analyse your data to identify insights that can inform your design requirements.

Your task

Read the mock interview transcripts below. Note: these are completely fictional interview transcripts. Discuss with your classmates (in groups) the following:

- (1) **Coding the data** - What codes (i.e., labels) would you give to each section of the transcript? You might find there are words the participants use that would be good codes. Think of as many codes as you can. Each code should represent an issue or concern the participants have mentioned. Write each of these issues or concerns on a separate post-it note. You can do this together or individually. Spend about 10 minutes on this task.
- (2) **Clustering the codes into themes** – In your groups, work together to place your post-it notes into groups according to similarity. Are there any issues or concerns that seem to belong together? How would you cluster the codes into themes? You can rearrange your post-it notes until you are satisfied that you have created a coherent set of themes.
- (3) **Finalise your themes** – Label your clusters of post-it notes. These are your themes. Prepare a brief description of each theme to share with the class.

Mock interview transcript A

Personalise Information, Time period, Food, Problem, Emotion, solution

Interviewee (A) – Woman in early 40s, works full-time, married with school-aged children

Q: I want to ask some questions about meal planning. Let's start with breakfast: Can you tell me how you normally plan your breakfast?

A: *Oh, I don't have much time to plan breakfast. Sometimes if things are really busy I don't eat breakfast at all. Mornings are so hectic. I have to get the kids to childcare and then get to work on time and it's usually a miracle if I get out the door in one piece. If I'm lucky I'll have time to grab a*

bowl of cereal or some toast, but I certainly don't do anything fancy for breakfast.

Q: It sounds like mornings are really busy for you. You said you sometimes don't have time to eat breakfast at all. Can you tell me a bit more about what it's like when you don't have breakfast?

A: *I hate skipping breakfast but sometimes I have to because there's just not enough time. I always make sure the kids have breakfast, but if we're running late, I will not eat. The problem is that then I get really hungry after I get to work. We often have a team meeting over coffee in the mid-morning and if I haven't had breakfast at home, I will get a slice of cake to eat with my coffee. It's not great and I don't feel good about it but it's the first chance I get to eat and there's not much healthy food available at the café.*

Q: What about other meals? What do you do for lunch?

A: *Well, I don't pack lunch to take with me to work! There's absolutely no time in the morning to do that. So, yeah, I normally go to the café again for lunch. On a good day I'll get a salad but often I'll see the pies and just feel like having something warming and filling. I'm very swayed by what I see on display at the café. Sometimes I'll go out for lunch with colleagues, and we usually choose the burger or pizza shop nearby. More unhealthy food! If I'm at home, I'll just eat whatever the kids are eating – usually sandwiches. Very occasionally I'll be organised enough to make soup and put some in the freezer for lunches. But that doesn't happen often because I have to make sure I have all the ingredients on hand, which means doing the shopping, and it takes time to chop and cook up the vegetables.*

Q: And how do you plan your evening meals?

A: *Oh, we are a bit more organised with the evening meal. We usually sit together as a family and my husband and I take it in turns to cook. We try to choose healthy meals, but our choices depend on what everyone will eat. So we eat a lot of pasta because that's what the kids will eat without fuss and it's fairly easy to whip up quickly. Certainly no gourmet meals in our house! We try to make sure we get all the food for the evening meals in our weekly shop, but sometimes forget things and that makes it difficult to cook the meals we want to cook. If there's a key ingredient missing it can derail the whole meal plan. With young kids it's not so easy to duck out to the shops every time we've forgotten something. So we try to be creative if we have to, but honestly I'm so tired at the end of the day, the last thing I have energy for is creative cooking. So we keep it plain and simple as much as possible. It's boring, but at least the kids are fed.*

Q: It must be difficult to fit in time to exercise. Can you tell me about the last time you were able to do a physical activity, like go for a walk or a swim?

A: *Yeah, it's hard to find time for exercise. I used to go to the gym in the mornings, but obviously can't do that now because mornings are too hectic. I do get out on the weekends though. I try to go for a walk on my own if I can and if I can't, I'll take the kids to the park, and we might kick the ball around. It's not ideal and nothing like the level of activity I used to do, but it's better than nothing. When was the last time I did a physical activity? Oh, I did go to the pool on the weekend and swam*

some laps while the kids were at their swimming lessons. It's not something I normally do, but I finally got their lessons lined up at the same time, so I get 30 minutes to myself. All I wanted to do was sit on the bench looking at my phone, but I forced myself to get in the water and must admit, I did feel better afterwards, despite the hassle of having to get changed. Yeah, I might do that next time too.

Q: "So it sounds like you fit in exercise when you can. Do you do anything else to maintain an exercise routine?"

A: No, and that's a problem. I'd really like it to be a daily or weekly habit but it's so hard to fit it in in the morning and by the evening I'm too tired. So I exercise sporadically at best. I'd love to be able to be more methodical about it and have a regular routine. To be honest, I'm waiting for the kids to get older so I can do that. There have been times when I've tried to do workouts at home but I haven't stuck to it. What happens is someone gets sick or things get busy at work and I skip my usual session for a day or two and before you know it, I've stopped doing it at all. It's really difficult to maintain the habit of exercising regularly. As soon as something throws me off course I have trouble getting back on. And so I'll have a sudden burst of motivation and energy – like the swim last weekend – but it doesn't last. It will all fall apart after a few weeks when something goes wrong.

Mock interview transcript B

Interviewee (B) – Man in mid-20s, studies and works part-time, single, lives in share house

Q: I want to ask some questions about meal planning. Let's start with breakfast: Can you tell me how you normally plan your breakfast?

B: I usually go to the gym before breakfast, and then I'm often in a hurry to get to class so I want something quick and easy but healthy. I think protein is important because I don't want to lose muscle mass. So, I usually have a protein shake for breakfast. It's not that hard to plan – I just need to make sure I've got the ingredients I need at home. I order the protein powder online and I always order the next batch when I can see I've only got a week's worth left in the tin. So that's breakfast most mornings and it's pretty easy. I'm usually in a hurry to catch the train to get to class and I don't want anything that takes too much time. But when I don't have a class to get to, I will make a big fry up – eggs, bacon, that sort of thing. That takes a bit longer to prepare.

Q: "That sounds good. How often would you do that?"

B: Probably a few times a week. Weekends, definitely. I usually sleep in a bit and have a more leisurely breakfast. And there is at least one day during the week when I don't have a morning class so I'm not in such a hurry and can take a bit more time preparing and eating breakfast. But I also don't want to do that too often because it's not good for me. I like it but always feel like I've over indulged. It's a treat really

Q: "And what do you need to do to plan for that sort of breakfast?"

B: Just make sure I've got the ingredients in the fridge. I'll buy eggs and bacon and bread in my weekly shop so they are always there. I also need to make sure I've got time to clean up afterwards. I used to cook a fry up and then have to run to uni or work and I'd come back to find an angry note in

the kitchen from my flatmate. So now I always clean up afterwards, but that makes it pretty time consuming. So that's another reason to have a protein shake for breakfast. I don't have as much to clean up – it's quicker to make, quicker to eat (or I should say drink), and quicker to clean up afterwards.

Q: "Yes, I imagine that's important when you live with other people. What about during the day? How do you plan your meals when you're at uni?"

B: I try to make a sandwich that I can take in my bag, but I don't always do this. It's a bit annoying having to carry my lunch around. I can't keep it cold, and it takes up space in my bag. Plus, there's the time it takes to prepare lunch. Sometimes I just can't be bothered, and I think, stuff it, I'll get some food from one of the restaurants on campus. But then it's annoying when I do that because it costs money and there isn't much healthy food that you can buy. I'm often really hungry by the time I get a break for lunch. Like, really hungry – starving, hangry [laughs]. And if I'm really hungry there's no way I'm just going to buy a salad for my lunch. I'll get pizza or a burrito or something that I know will fill me up but isn't always healthy. Yeah, thinking about it, I guess there are a few days a week I'll buy something unhealthy for lunch.

Q: How does that make you feel?

B: Oh, I'm not too bothered, really. I mean I feel like maybe it's not good for me, but I go to the gym a lot so, I don't know, maybe it's okay. But I guess it would be better if I could take food in with me most days, so I know what I'm eating and I know it's healthy. Also it would cost less!

Q: What would help you do that?

B: Having somewhere to store my food on campus. Also maybe having something other than sandwiches that I could make easily and that is easy to transport. I guess more ideas about what I could pack in my lunch box. I tried to look for ideas online once but the only things that came up were suggestions for parents packing school lunch boxes. I want to know how to feed someone like me on the go – I need a lot of food by the time I hit the middle of the day.

Q. What about evening meals? How do you plan those?

B: I don't! I work at a pub a few nights a week and get food there. Usually hot chips. When I'm at home I might get something delivered. And sometimes I'll cook pasta or something but not very often. I'm never really in the mood to cook in the evening. I can't be stuffed getting all the ingredients and doing all the cleaning up. Nah, I'd prefer to buy food when I'm hungry. Again, it's not very health food. Probably better if I did cook something.

Q. What about exercise? You said before that you go to the gym a lot.

B: Yeah, I try to go to the gym most mornings, not so much on weekends because I work late those nights. But Mon to Fri I'll be at the gym doing some weights and cardio work. I have a program I'm following, and I change that up every now and then. It gets a bit boring sometimes, but I'd rather go than not go. I can listen to music or podcasts to make it more interesting. And I feel better when I've been to gym in the morning.

Q. What about the rest of the time? You said you don't go to gym on weekends.

B: Nah, I'm a bit of a couch potato on weekends. I'm tired after work and I usually have assignments to work on and sometimes I might be catching up with friends. I don't do much in the way of exercise on those days to be honest. Give myself a bit of a break.

Mock interview transcript 3

Interviewee: Man, mid-50s, works full-time, married, with older children

Q: I want to ask some questions about meal planning. Let's start with breakfast: Can you tell me how you normally plan your breakfast?

C: *Oh, that's an interesting question. I don't think I've ever actually planned my breakfast! I always the same thing for breakfast – a bowl of weetbix. It's what I've been having since I was a kid. That probably makes me a bit boring, doesn't it? I just find it easier though, than trying to do something different. I always try to get to work early so I'm trying to be super efficient in the mornings. I just need to grab something quick to eat and head out the door. I'm trying to beat the traffic. If I leave too late it's chaos. There are times when I sleep in late or I'm running a bit behind in the morning because I need to drop one of the kids off at the station or I took the dog for a longer walk or whatever and I miss my window for breakfast, and then I'll just go to work without it. I'd rather get out of the house before peak hour hits than stay behind to eat breakfast.*

Q: And what happens when you miss breakfast?

C: *Now that's where I don't have good habits! There is a McDonalds close to where I work, and I'll stop in there for a McMuffin [laughs]*

Q: How often does that happen?

C: *More than it should to be honest. Probably once a week at least, sometimes twice. Now that I think about it, it's a pretty bad habit that I have. I thought it was only occasionally, but yeah, thinking about it, it would be at least once or twice a week. Oops!*

Q: And then how do you plan lunch when you're at work?

C: *Lunch is usually a working lunch. I often have a meeting with colleagues or clients and we would go to a restaurant. There are a few restaurants nearby that serve pizza and pasta, that sort of thing, for lunch. Probably have a glass of wine or two. And if it's a long meeting we'll stay for coffee and maybe have a slice of cake as well. It's not really healthy now that I think about it! When I don't have a lunch meeting I'll grab a quick bite to eat at our canteen. It's a pretty good canteen. Lots of options. But to be honest, I'm not very tempted by the healthy stuff. I see all the salads and they look like they wouldn't fill me up, so I usually get a pie or a bowl of pasta.*

Q: Do you ever bring a packed lunch to work?

C: *No, never! I'd have to be more organised for that. Like I said, I try to be pretty efficient in the mornings. I just want to get out the door and in the car before the traffic starts building up. So I definitely don't want to make lunch in the mornings! My wife does because she's trying to be healthy. She'll take leftovers or make a salad. And my kids will make sandwiches. That means the kitchen is pretty busy in the morning. It's peak hour in our kitchen. Everyone is trying to get to work, uni, school, at the same time. So it would be annoying if I was trying to make lunch at the same time. Much easier to have a quick breakfast and get out the door, then buy lunch on the fly when I'm at work.*

Q: How do you feel about the way you fit in food during the day?

C: *Oh, look, to be honest, I enjoy the restaurant meals and the canteen pies are okay. But I do tend to feel a bit sluggish in the afternoon, especially after a long lunchtime meeting with wine and cake! I*

know it's not good for me. I'm sitting for much of the day too. So, I'm having a big stodgy meal and then sitting in a meeting room or at my desk. It's probably not a very healthy lifestyle. Actually, my doctor has been saying I need to reduce my blood pressure and that I might be pre-diabetic. Somehow over the last few years I have gotten into bad habits with food, and I'm at an age where I probably should do something about it before it's too late.

Q: That sounds like something you are concerned about. What do you think would help to change the habits?

C: I guess making it easier to eat healthily. Right now, unhealthy meals are so convenient. It would be good if it was just as easy and enjoyable to choose to eat a healthy meal during the day as it is to eat the pizza, pasta and pies that I tend to go for. But, like I said, salads look boring to me and I don't think they would fill me up.

Q. Anything else?

C: I guess having more information about what's in the meals I'm eating would be useful too. I don't need to be told that a McMuffin is unhealthy, I already know that! But if I'm eating out for lunch, it would be helpful to know what kind of impact each meal is likely to have. Like, this meal has so many calories. But not just how many calories because that doesn't mean much really, does it? It would be useful to have information about what you need to do to burn off those calories. Something like, if you eat this meal you should go for a 1-hour run later to make up for it.

Q. Great idea! What about evening meals? How do you plan those?

C: Well, evening meals are a different story all together. My wife and I both work and our kids are at high school and uni so they have their own schedule, but we try to find out who is going to be home for dinner and when, and we plan our menu in advance each week. That way we can do all the shopping on the weekend and know exactly what we need to get for all the meals we are making. I usually cook a couple of meals, my wife cooks a few times, and we treat ourselves to a takeaway meal on Friday nights. We mostly eat healthy meals at night, but they're pretty easy to make.

Q. What about exercise? Can you tell me how you fit activity into your day?

C: To be honest, apart from walking the dog in the morning, I really don't do that much. I'll do a bit of work around the house on weekends and that gets me out doing stuff. It sort of feels like a gym session. But, yeah, I should really do more. The morning walk is good but it's pretty short and slow, and then I'm just sitting for the rest of the day not doing anything. And as I said before, I need to be a bit more careful with the blood pressure and pre-diabetes. I should really be trying to do more with exercise, but it's hard to fit it in. Life's pretty busy, you know.